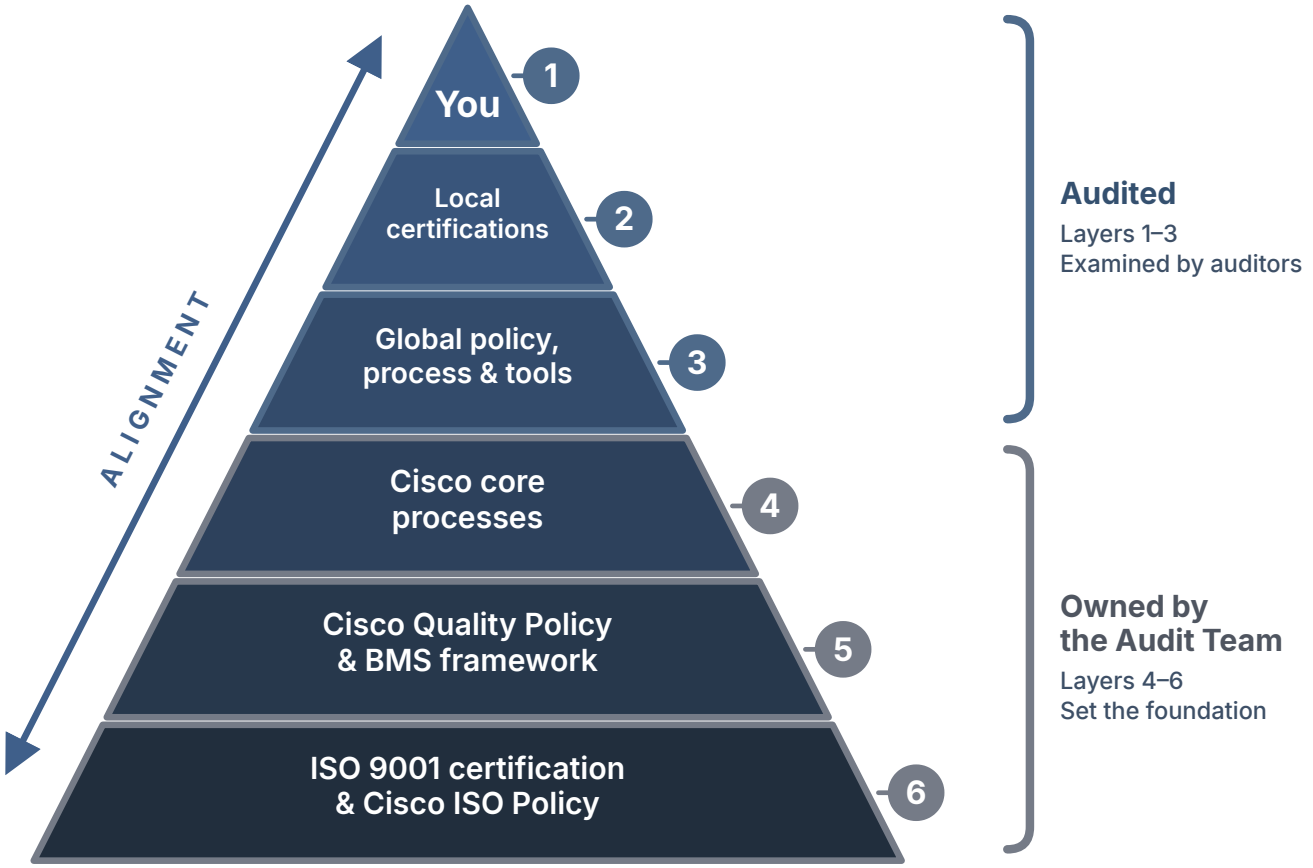
BUSINESS MANAGEMENT SYSTEM · JOB AID

The BMS Pyramid

How an ISO certificate connects to the work you do

WHAT IT ILLUSTRATES

The BMS Pyramid illustrates how high-level business requirements are translated into the policies, processes, and day-to-day activities that guide our work.



Read it top to bottom
Start with you at the top and work down to the ISO 9001 foundation.

Alignment runs both ways
Every layer lines up, from the standard to you and back.

Know who looks after what
Layers 1–3 are audited. Layers 4–6 are owned by the Audit Team.

The six layers

From you at the top to the foundation at the bottom. Numbers match the pyramid.

1 You — Audited

Governance and accountability, based on your role and responsibilities.

PLAN, DO, CHECK, ACT: Plan | Do | Check | Act

2 Local certifications — Audited

The product, service, and geographic standards that apply to your work.

EXAMPLES: ISO 45000 | ISO 14000 | IECEx | TL 9000 | ISO 22301 | SaaS certifications | and more

3 Global policy, process, and tools — Audited

Where requirements become the lifecycles and tools your team works in every day.

LIFECYCLES: Engineering CPDM | CX TAC | SCO QMOS | GBR | ERIM | STO | etc.

TOOLS: Docs | Box | SharePoint | DCP | SFDC | ESP | CCF | etc.

4 Cisco core processes — Owned by the Audit Team

Embedded across the whole company. These are the processes every team shares.

PROCESSES: Management review | Information management | Training | Corrective action | Change management | Internal auditing

5 Cisco Quality Policy and BMS framework — Owned by the Audit Team

How Cisco puts ISO 9001 into practice.

IN PRACTICE: BMS framework deployed company-wide | Included in the Code of Business Conduct (COBC)

6 ISO 9001 certification and Cisco ISO Policy — Owned by the Audit Team

The foundation of the pyramid.

CERTIFICATION: Attests to quality across all of Cisco

ISO POLICY: Mandates ISO 9001 adoption worldwide

How you contribute

Every employee helps hold the pyramid up in three ways.

1. **Follow established processes**
2. **Meet the requirements for your role**
3. **Help improve the way Cisco operates**

The certification is the foundation. You are the peak. The pyramid holds when you do your part.